

Attraction tactics: White, move 40

Attraction tactics

White to move

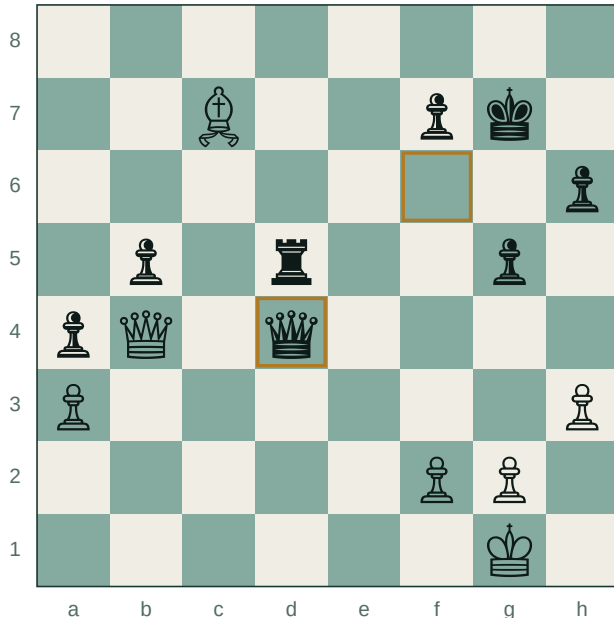
WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.



Previous move: 39...Qd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40. Qxd4+ Rxd4 41. Be5+ Kg6 42. Bxd4

40.Qxd4+ Check restricts Black to 7 legal replies here. From d4 it attacks king on g7 and rook on d5. Recorded reply: **40...Rxd4.**

41.Be5+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From e5 it attacks king on g7 and rook on d4. Recorded reply: **41...Kg6.**

42.Bxd4 The bishop captures the rook on d4.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -3 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.